

7.10b

Describing trends 2

Worksheet

- D** Fill in the gaps using words from the box.

because because of led to although in spite of due to resulted in whereas

Cause and result

- 1 Profits increased last month _____ / _____ our new sales campaign.
- 2 Profits increased last month _____ we had a new sales campaign.
- 3 Our new sales campaign _____ / _____ an increase in profits last month.

Contrast

- 4 We had a reasonable year in Asia, _____ sales fell a little in Japan.
- 5 _____ the fall in sales in Japan, we did quite well in the rest of Asia.
- 6 Sales in Asia last year were quite strong, _____ the previous year had been very disappointing.

although / in spite of / whereas

- Although In example 4 above the main information is about Asia. The other fact introduced by *although* (about Japan) contrasts with it and is surprising.
- In spite of In example 5 the main information is also about Asia. Now it is this that seems surprising.
- Whereas In example 6 there is a comparison of information of equal importance and no surprise.

- Look back at examples 4–6 and make grammar rules by crossing out the wrong words:

although / in spite of / whereas is followed by a noun clause (no verb).

although / in spite of / whereas are followed by subject + verb.

- E** One of these phrases sounds strange. Which one? What is the problem?

Prices increased We increased our prices Prices fell We fell our prices

Read the information about 'Types of verb' and complete the examples with words from the box.

grow increase cut go down decrease maintain

Types of verb

- 1 Transitive/Intransitive verbs can be used with or without an object.
We'll improve/recover/ _____ / _____ our market share.
And, using the same verbs:
Our market share will improve/recover/ _____ / _____.
- 2 Transitive verbs are always followed by an object.
We'll raise/lower/ _____ / _____ her salary.
(*But not* Her salary will raise.)
- 3 Intransitive verbs are never followed by an object.
Inflation will rise/fall/ _____ / _____.
(*But not* This policy will rise inflation.)

- F** Refer back to section B. This time prepare a written presentation on trends in your imaginary company. Use a good variety of language for describing and explaining trends.